CONNECT
LEAD
TRANSFORM

Proposal for the Coordination of the Interamerican Youth Network

Said Ortega
Candidate for Coordinator
Interamerican Youth Network
Interamerican Region – Scout Movement

SCOUTS
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Initial Message

When I think about the Interamerican Youth Network, I think of a community of young people from different countries who share the same conviction: that youth participation can strengthen the Scout Movement and generate a positive impact in our communities.

Throughout my experience in Scouting, I have had the opportunity to meet young leaders from across the region, listen to their ideas, and understand the challenges our youth networks face. These conversations have reaffirmed something important: youth participation needs spaces, but also clear structures, constant communication, and follow-up on ideas that emerge from young people.

The Connect, Lead, Transform proposal seeks precisely that: to strengthen the Interamerican Youth Network as an organized, connected space with real capacity for impact within the region.

More than creating new structures, this proposal aims to organize, strengthen, and give continuity to the work that already exists, so that the network can generate sustainable results throughout the triennium.

— Said Ortega

Who is Said Ortega?

I am Said Ortega, a young Scout from Panama who deeply believes in the power of youth participation.

My journey in the Scout Movement began more than nine years ago, and since then Scouting has taught me something that guides my leadership today: when young people have real spaces to participate, they can generate incredible change.

Currently, I serve as National Commissioner for Youth Participation of the National Scout Association of Panama and as Deputy Leader of Scout Group 15 Juan Demóstenes Arosemena, where I continue supporting young people in their leadership journey.

Outside of Scouting, I am a Law student, I work in the field of local government, and I am a volunteer with the Panamanian Red Cross.

I am passionate about youth leadership, international relations, and connecting young people from different countries. I firmly believe that when young people connect, share ideas, and work together, they can transform the Scout Movement and their communities.

El camino que me trajo hasta aquí

2015

Joined the Scout Movement, beginning my development process within the Scout Youth Programme.

2019

Achieved the highest progression award in the Scout section: Scout Balboa.

2022

Achieved the highest progression award in the intermediate section: Isthmian Distinction.

2023

2023-2027
Elected Deputy Director of the Youth Body, Arraiján Committee of the Panamanian Red Cross.

2023 – 2025
Elected National Youth Participation Advisor at the National Youth Forum of the Scout Association of Panama.

2024

2024
Achieved the highest progression award in the senior section: BP Rover Award.

2024
National School Sector Coordinator, Youth Body of the Panamanian Red Cross.

2024
Elected Deputy Leader of Scout Group 15 Juan Demóstenes Arosemena.

2024
Recognized as Messenger of Peace for the project "Del Timbo al Tambo".

2024
Recognized as Champion for Nature for the project "Woofing Hearts".

2024
Deputy Director of the Panamanian Leadership Course 2024.

2024
Participant in the Interamerican Leadership Training (Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic).

2025

2025 – 2027
Appointed National Commissioner for Youth Participation of the Scout Association of Panama.

2025
Diploma in Organizational Leadership and Managerial Skills with AI – University of Santander.

2025
Participant in the Messenger of Peace: Driving Youth-Led Change Workshop (Riyadh, Saudi Arabia).

2026

2026
Director of the Panamanian Leadership Course 2026.

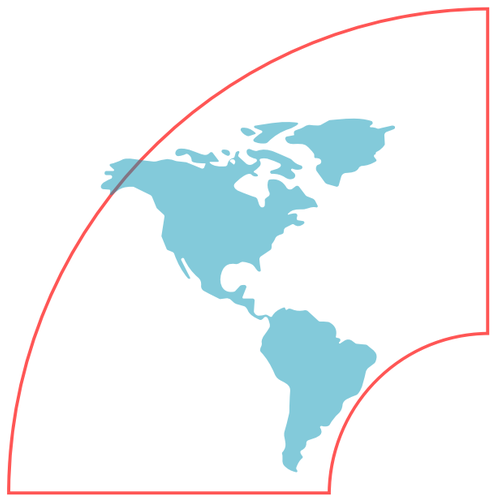
2026
Lead contributor to the update of the National Youth Participation Policy of Scouts Panama.

Regional Diagnosis

Regional Diagnosis

In recent years, the Interamerican Youth Network has represented an important platform for promoting youth participation within the Scout Movement across the region. Through initiatives such as the Youth Network Meeting and the Interamerican Youth Forum, opportunities have been created for engagement, exchange of experiences, and dialogue among young leaders from different National Scout Organizations.

These spaces have strengthened the sense of community among youth networks and have helped to elevate youth perspectives within regional processes. They have also contributed to increasing youth engagement in reflecting on the present and future of Scouting in the Interamerican region.



However, several challenges remain that limit the network's full potential. These include the need to strengthen mechanisms for continuous communication among youth networks, improve regional coordination throughout the year, and establish clearer processes for following up on recommendations generated in youth spaces.

Additionally, there is a significant opportunity to strengthen the articulation between the Interamerican Youth Network and the regional structures of the Scout Movement, ensuring that ideas and proposals generated by young people can have greater influence within institutional processes.

In this context, strengthening the Interamerican Youth Network requires progress toward a structure that effectively combines dialogue spaces, sustained coordination mechanisms, and tools that enable proper follow-up on youth contributions.

This diagnosis highlights the need to consolidate a network that operates in a more organized, connected, and articulated manner with regional processes, thereby enhancing youth leadership and the exchange of experiences among National Scout Organizations across the region.

Guiding Principles of this Initiative

The work of the Interamerican Youth Network during the 2025–2028 triennium will be guided by a set of principles aimed at strengthening responsible, collaborative, and results-oriented youth participation.

MEANINGFUL PARTICIPATION

Youth participation must ensure that the voices of young people are heard and taken into account within the processes of the Scout Movement. This implies creating spaces where ideas can be transformed into concrete proposals.

REGIONAL COLLABORATION

The Interamerican Youth Network should function as a platform that promotes the exchange of experiences, mutual learning, and joint work among National Scout Organizations.

TRANSPARENCY AND OPEN COMMUNICATION

The network's processes must be carried out with clarity, access to information, and communication mechanisms that allow youth networks to stay informed and actively participate.

FOLLOW-UP AND INSTITUTIONAL ACCOUNTABILITY

The proposals and recommendations generated by young people must have clear follow-up mechanisms that allow for the evaluation of progress and the strengthening of youth influence within regional processes.

Triennium Vision

During the 2025–2028 period, the Interamerican Youth Network aims to consolidate itself as an active, connected regional space with the capacity to generate real impact within the Scout Movement.

The vision for this triennium is summarized in three clear aspirations:

A connected network

Where youth networks from National Scout Organizations maintain continuous communication, share experiences, and actively collaborate throughout the year.

A leading network

Capable of generating ideas, proposals, and recommendations that contribute to the development of the Scout Movement in the region.

A transforming network

Where youth ideas are not only expressed, but also find clear mechanisms for follow-up and alignment with regional processes.

This vision seeks for the Interamerican Youth Network to be recognized as a space for regional collaboration, youth leadership, and collective building, strengthening both the present and the future of the Scout Movement in the Americas.

The vision for the 2025–2028 triennium aims to consolidate a more connected Interamerican Youth Network, with active leadership and the capacity to generate impact within the Scout Movement.

Triennium Vision	Strategic Axes
Connect youth networks across the region	Permanent Regional Connection
Strengthen youth leadership	Youth Innovation Labs
Transform ideas into action	Youth Participation Observatory

Strategic Axis 1 Interamerican Youth Participation Observatory

Purpose

The Interamerican Youth Participation Observatory aims to strengthen knowledge and visibility of youth participation experiences within National Scout Organizations across the region. In many cases, youth networks develop valuable initiatives in their countries, but these experiences are not always documented or shared at the regional level.

The Observatory seeks to become a simple tool to collect, organize, and disseminate best practices, enabling youth networks to learn from one another and strengthen their own participation processes.

Lines of Action

Regional Mapping of Youth Participation

During the first year of the triennium, a simple mapping of existing youth networks in the region will be conducted, identifying:

- Youth participation structures
- Youth-led initiatives
- Decision-making spaces where young people are involved

This mapping will provide an overall understanding of the state of youth participation in the region.

Documentation of Best Practices

Each year, selected outstanding youth participation experiences from different countries will be identified. These experiences will be briefly documented in order to share lessons learned with the rest of the region.

Regional Youth Participation Report

Based on the information collected, an annual regional report on youth participation will be developed. This report will help identify progress, challenges, and opportunities to strengthen youth leadership.

How will it be implemented?

To ensure sustainability for coordinators:

- Simple digital forms will be used to collect information from youth networks
- Youth networks will be encouraged to voluntarily share their experiences
- Data collection and systematization will be carried out progressively throughout the year

Expected Results

- Greater knowledge of youth participation models across the region
- Exchange of experiences among National Scout Organizations
- Increased visibility of youth leadership within the Interamerican Scout Movement

STRATEGIC AXIS 2
Scout Youth Innovation Labs

Purpose

The Scout Youth Innovation Labs will serve as collaborative spaces designed for young people from different countries to reflect on shared challenges within the Scout Movement and generate ideas to strengthen Scouting in the region.

These labs are not intended to be complex processes, but rather dynamic spaces for exchange and co-creation, where participants can share experiences, identify challenges, and propose solutions.

Lines of Action

Thematic Virtual Sessions

Two to three virtual labs will be organized annually, focusing on key regional topics such as:

- Youth participation and leadership
- Innovation in the Youth Programme
- Youth communication
- Social impact and community projects

Exchange of Experiences

During the labs, participants will have the opportunity to present ongoing initiatives within their organizations, fostering peer learning.

Generation of Ideas and Recommendations

Each lab will aim to produce concrete ideas or recommendations that can be shared at the regional level.

Implementation Approach

- Labs will be conducted in a virtual format to facilitate regional participation
- Simple digital tools will be used (e.g., breakout rooms, collaborative dynamics) to encourage active engagement

Expected Outcomes

- Increased exchange of ideas among young leaders from different countries
- Generation of proposals to strengthen the Scout Movement in the region
- Promotion of a culture of innovation within the Interamerican Youth Network

STRATEGIC AXIS 3
Permanent Regional Connection among Youth Networks

Purpose

The Permanent Regional Connection among Youth Networks aims to strengthen communication and collaboration among youth networks of National Scout Organizations throughout the year.

While the region already benefits from key spaces such as the Regional Youth Network Meeting and the Interamerican Youth Forum, this axis seeks to complement those efforts through continuous communication channels that sustain dialogue and cooperation across countries.

Lines of Action

Periodic Regional Meetings

Regular virtual meetings will be organized among youth networks to share progress, challenges, and national experiences.

These meetings will also serve to keep networks informed about regional processes and participation opportunities.

Regional Communication Network

The creation of accessible communication channels will be promoted, including:

- A regional WhatsApp community for rapid communication among youth representatives
- A collaborative workspace (e.g., Slack or similar platforms) for thematic discussions
- Periodic newsletters or email updates to share news and opportunities

Dissemination of Regional Opportunities

These channels will also facilitate the sharing of:

- Regional calls and opportunities
- Youth events
- Projects and experiences developed by youth networks

Sustainability Measures

- Designation of focal points for each national youth network
- Use of simple and accessible communication tools
- Regional meetings held every three to four months to avoid overburdening participants

Expected Outcomes

- Strengthened communication among youth networks across the region
- Enhanced sense of community within the Interamerican Youth Network
- Increased opportunities for collaboration among young leaders from different countries

MANAGEMENT MODEL AND TEAM STRUCTURE

Working Teams

LThe implementation of this proposal will be based on a collaborative management model that promotes the active participation of young people from different National Scout Organizations and strengthens the work of the Interamerican Youth Network.

This model aims to foster a dynamic network in which initiatives can be developed in an organized manner, promoting regional collaboration and youth leadership.

To facilitate the implementation of the proposed initiatives, the establishment of thematic working teams will be encouraged, composed of young people interested in contributing to the strengthening of the network and the development of its projects.

Communications and Networks Team

This team will aim to strengthen communication within the Interamerican Youth Network and enhance the visibility of youth-led initiatives across the region.

Key responsibilities include:

- Supporting the dissemination of network activities and initiatives
- Strengthening communication channels among youth networks
- Sharing opportunities, projects, and experiences from different countries
- Contributing to the visibility of the network's work

Projects and Innovation Team

This team will support the development of initiatives and innovation spaces that strengthen youth leadership in the region.

Key responsibilities include:

- Supporting the implementation of the Interamerican Youth Participation Observatory
- Collaborating in the organization of the Scout Youth Innovation Labs
- Promoting the exchange of ideas and projects among youth networks
- Exploring new opportunities to strengthen youth participation

Translation Team

Considering the linguistic diversity of the Interamerican region, this team will contribute to facilitating communication and exchange among young people from different countries.

Key responsibilities include:

- Supporting the translation of materials, documents, and initiatives
- Facilitating communication among youth networks with different languages
- Contributing to making regional spaces more accessible

These teams will operate in a flexible and collaborative manner, allowing young people from different countries to contribute based on their skills, interests, and experiences.

Through this model, the proposal seeks to strengthen regional participation, facilitate the development of youth-led initiatives, and promote a more connected and active network.

TRIENNIAL IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

YEAR 1 – EXPLORATION AND CONNECTION

The first year will focus on strengthening connections among youth networks in the region and establishing the foundations for the proposed initiatives.

Key actions:

- Establishment of regional communication channels among youth networks
- Identification of focal points within national youth networks
- Launch of the regional youth participation mapping for the Observatory
- Organization of the first Scout Youth Innovation Labs
- Formation of thematic working teams (communications, projects, and translations)

This phase will build a solid foundation for regional collaboration and participation.

YEAR 2 – DEVELOPMENT AND INNOVATION

The second year will focus on consolidating the initiatives developed and strengthening regional exchange spaces.

Key actions:

- Publication of the first regional report of the Interamerican Youth Participation Observatory
- Organization of additional Scout Youth Innovation Labs focused on regional challenges
- Strengthening of regional communication channels among youth networks
- Promotion of the exchange of experiences and good practices among countries
- Continuity of the thematic working teams

This phase will expand the reach of the initiatives and reinforce collaborative work across the region.

YEAR 3 – CONSOLIDATION AND IMPACT

The third year will focus on consolidating the initiatives and strengthening their impact within the region.

Key actions:

- Publication of a new edition of the regional youth participation report
- Systematization of learnings generated through the Innovation Labs
- Strengthening of the regional communication network
- Identification of recommendations and future opportunities for the network
- Preparation of a triennial results report summarizing achievements

This phase will ensure the consolidation of a more connected network, with stronger exchange of experiences and impactful youth-led initiatives.

MONITORING AND EVALUATION SYSTEM

Monitoring and Evaluation System

he implementation of this proposal will include a monitoring and evaluation system based on Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), enabling the tracking of progress, identification of improvement opportunities, and assessment of results throughout the triennium.

This system aims to ensure that implemented actions effectively contribute to strengthening the Interamerican Youth Network, promoting a results-based, transparent, and continuously improving management approach.

Monitoring will be conducted through indicators aligned with the three strategic axes, measuring both participation levels and the impact of initiatives.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Regional Connection among Youth Networks:

- Number of youth networks actively engaged in regional communication channels
- Number of regional meetings held annually
- Level of participation in regional dialogue spaces

Scout Youth Innovation Labs:

- Number of labs conducted during the triennium
- Number of participating youth from different National Scout Organizations
- Number of ideas, proposals, or initiatives generated

Interamerican Youth Participation Observatory:

- Number of youth networks contributing information or experiences
- Publication of reports or documents on youth participation
- Number of good practices identified and shared regionally

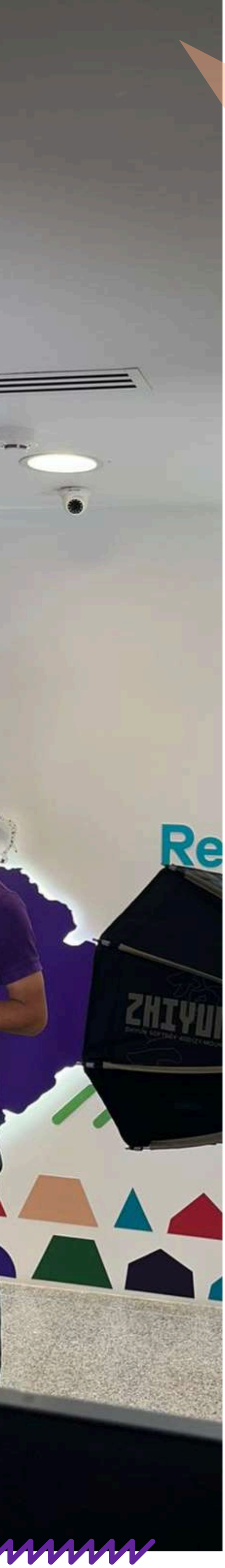
Triennial Progress Evaluation

Progress will be periodically reviewed based on these indicators, enabling:

- Identification of achievements in implementation
- Recognition of challenges and improvement opportunities
- Adjustment of strategies to enhance overall impact

This approach ensures that implementation remains flexible, transparent, and results-oriented.

- 10+ youth networks actively connected at the regional level
- 6–9 Innovation Labs conducted
- 3 Observatory reports published
- 100+ young people participating in regional spaces
- New youth-led initiatives shared across countries



FINAL MESSAGE

Since its origins, the Scout Movement has been a commitment to young people — to their capacity to learn, to lead, and to transform the world around them.

When Robert Baden-Powell founded the Scout Movement, he made a decision that would shape the history of youth leadership: to trust young people. To believe that, when given real opportunities to participate, they are capable of taking responsibility, making decisions, and building a better world. More than a century later, that vision remains fully relevant.

Today, our responsibility as a region is not only to invite young people to participate, but to create the conditions for them to lead.

This proposal is grounded in a clear conviction: a more connected, active, and collaborative Interamerican Youth Network can significantly strengthen the Scout Movement in our region

Let us connect our networks.
Share our experiences.
Drive new ideas forward.

and expand opportunities for young people to shape its future.

This plan is an invitation:

- An invitation to believe in the power of youth leadership.
- An invitation to build together a more dynamic, participatory, and transformative network.
- And above all, an invitation to continue trusting young people.

Because the future of the Scout Movement in our region does not depend solely on young people who are ready to lead — it depends on our collective ability to trust them, create space, and move forward together.

PANAMA
15
INTERAMERICAN LEADERS TRAINING
REGION SCOUT INTERAMERICAN
ASOCIACION NACIONAL DE SCOUTS PANAMA

More than a century ago, Baden-Powell chose to place his trust in young people.
Today, it is our responsibility to create the conditions that enable them to continue leading the future of the Scout Movement.

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